

YOU HAVE A CHOICE.

OCTOBER 8, 2026

One of nine is not an excuse.

Where was Kelly Backs' formal advocacy for the Roberts Creek OCPC?

Kelly says he fought to protect Roberts Creek's character during OCP renewal. Now he promises to engage the Official Community Plan Committee (OCPC) when a draft appears in 2027. But what happened when the committee asked to be involved in 2025? [1]

The existing Roberts Creek OCP identifies the Area Director as the OCPC's liaison. In 2023, the Board deferred Roberts Creek Park's long-term use to OCP renewal. Decisions affecting the community were already being shifted into that process. [2, 3]

In February 2025, the Board chose an integrated OCP and zoning bylaw. The OCPC asked to participate in renewal workshops. On March 27, the Board received its request "for information," without establishing the requested role. I have found no formal Board motion, amendment or comparable action by Kelly advocating for it in the decisions reviewed. [4, 5]

The Board proceeded with substantial drafting direction in 2026. The OCPC presented its own community report in July. Kelly's attendance at the OCPC had meanwhile fallen to one of six recorded meetings in the first half of 2026, with four regrets and one unclear entry. [6, 7]

Yet we know Kelly could bring a motion when he chose to. On February 26, 2026, he moved to direct staff to meet with the Sunshine Coast Pickleball Association. The Board passed his motion (044/26). Staff subsequently identified necessary OCP and zoning amendments, and noted the absence of a park plan or consensus about the site's future. [8, 9]

The pickleball proposal deserves a fair process. So did the OCPC's request. I have found clear formal Board advocacy by Kelly for the first, but no equivalent formal advocacy securing the OCPC's requested involvement. Informal efforts may have occurred; these records do not establish them. [5, 8]

Being one of nine limits a director to one vote. It is no excuse for failing to formally advocate. Kelly demonstrated exactly how to bring a motion and obtain Board direction.

Kelly, why was that formal leadership available to the SCPA in 2026 but not evident for the OCPC in 2025? And why should residents believe a new promise for 2027?

My first campaign outreach was to the OCPC. I requested a meeting September 8, attended September 15 and sought its counsel. [Read my statement](#)

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THE SEQUENCE

What the record shows

Earlier decisions, the OCPC request, and the contrasting 2026 Board motion.

2012	The adopted Roberts Creek OCP establishes the OCPC's community planning role and names the Area Director as liaison to the SCRD. [2]
2023	The Area D APC raises concerns about regional OCP amendment criteria. In June, the Board defers Roberts Creek Park's long-term land use to future OCP renewal. [3, 10]
Feb 2025	The Board chooses a single integrated OCP and zoning bylaw; an APC workshop is explicitly part of its direction. [4]
Mar 2025	The OCPC's request to participate in renewal workshops is received "for information." No equivalent OCPC workshop direction is recorded. [5]
Feb 2026	Kelly Backs brings a motion directing staff to meet with SCPA and report back. The Board adopts Resolution 044/26. [8]
Feb-May 2026	The OCPC independently organizes a community town hall and survey, producing its own local report. [7]
Jun-Jul 2026	OCP drafting direction advances. The OCPC presents its completed report to the committee in July. SCRD staff identify OCP, zoning and planning requirements for the pickleball proposal. [6, 9]
Oct 2026	Kelly promises OCPC engagement after the draft appears in 2027. His statement does not identify a successful formal action securing the committee's 2025 request. [1]

Two requests. Two recorded responses.

OCPC, 2025: Asks for a role in renewal workshops. Board receives request for information; no specified role recorded. [5]

SCPA, 2026: Kelly moves to direct staff to meet with the association about its proposed park facility. Motion carried. [8]

These are not identical requests and neither decision establishes the merits of either proposal. The comparison concerns the Director's documented use of formal Board advocacy.

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SUPPORTING EVIDENCE

Kelly's recorded OCPC attendance

Compiled from supplied OCPC minutes, 2023–June 2026. Blank months mean no minutes supplied, not absences.

Kelly Backs: OCPC meeting attendance recorded in minutes												
	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2023	✕ 17	● 21	✕ 21	● 18	● 16	● 20			– 19	A 17	● 21	
2024	● 16	● 20	✕ 19	● 16	● 21	● 18	– 23		– 17	✕ 15	● 20	
2025	● 21	✕ 25	● 18	● 14	● 20				● 16		● 18	
2026	✕ 20	✕ 17	✕ 10	● 21	? 19	✕ 9						

● Present ✕ Regrets – Not listed A Alternate attended ? Unclear Blank: No meeting minutes supplied for that month
Small number below symbol = day of meeting. May 2026 cannot be classified from the supplied minutes.

In 2026, Kelly is recorded present once, with four regrets and one unclear entry across six meetings. This supports a decline in recorded participation, not a claim about his motives or every contact outside meetings.

Primary sources

- [1] Kelly Backs: OCP renewal campaign statement
- [2] Roberts Creek OCP Bylaw 641, Appendix B
- [3] SCR D Board minutes, June 22, 2023, Resolution 182/23
- [4] SCR D Board resolution 061/25 and OCP engagement direction
- [5] SCR D Board minutes, March 27, 2025, Resolution 089/25
- [6] SCR D OCP renewal project updates, June–July 2026
- [7] OCPC town hall report, May 2026; OCPC minutes reviewed
- [8] SCR D Board Feb 26 agenda and adopted Resolution 044/26
- [9] SCR D EAS July 16, 2026 staff report, item 4.2
- [10] Area D APC March 2023 minutes (regional amendment policy)

This review identifies formal actions in the records examined; it does not rule out informal discussions or unrecorded interventions.